

Cybersecurity Threat Intelligence Report (2024–2025)

Internship Program – Task 1

Prepared By: Venkat Rajesh

~ Intern At Summerix Global

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1. Introduction

Modern businesses rely on digital systems for communication, financial transactions, cloud storage, and remote collaboration. While this digital transformation improves efficiency, it also increases exposure to cyber threats. Cybersecurity is no longer limited to protecting computers—it safeguards digital identities, business operations, customer trust, and national infrastructure.

During 2024–2025, cyberattacks have become more advanced due to the use of Artificial Intelligence, automation, and easily available hacking tools. Attackers are able to launch sophisticated phishing campaigns, exploit cloud environments, and target vulnerable smart devices with minimal technical knowledge.

Organizations today require a proactive security strategy instead of reacting after an attack occurs. Threat intelligence helps security teams understand emerging risks before they become major incidents.

Current Threat Landscape

Threat	Risk Level	Trend
AI-Powered Phishing	Very High	Increasing
Ransomware-as-a-Service	Critical	Increasing
Cloud Misconfiguration	High	Stable
IoT Attacks	High	Increasing
Zero-Day Exploits	Critical	Increasing

2. Threat Analysis

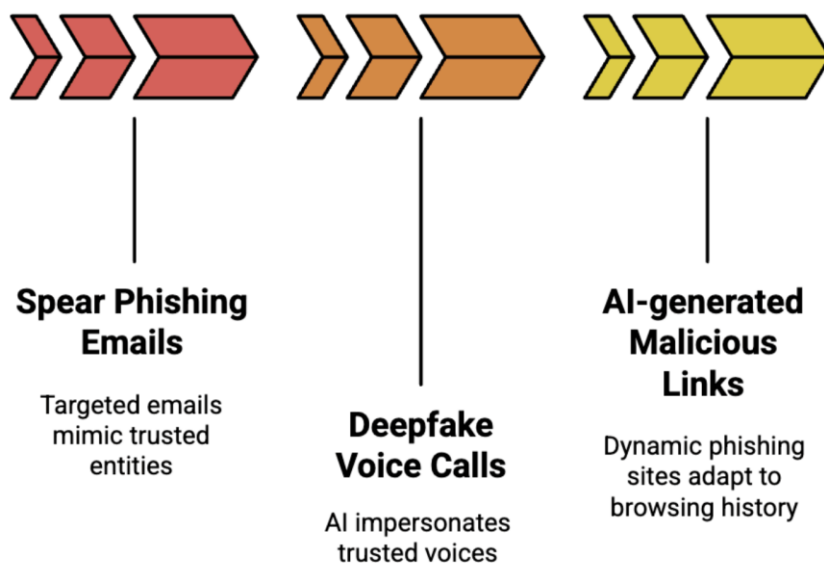
Threat 1 – AI-Powered Phishing Attacks

Overview

Traditional phishing relied on poorly written emails that were easy to recognize. Today, attackers use Artificial Intelligence to generate convincing emails, fake voice calls, and even deepfake videos. AI allows criminals to personalize attacks using publicly available information from social media and company websites.

Instead of sending thousands of random emails, attackers now create targeted messages that appear completely legitimate.

AI-Driven Phishing Attack Examples



Impact

Individuals

- Credential theft
- Banking fraud
- Identity theft
- Account takeover

Organizations

- Business Email Compromise (BEC)
- Financial loss
- Confidential information leakage
- Reputation damage

Real-World Case Study

In 2024, several multinational companies reported deepfake video conference scams where attackers impersonated senior executives and convinced employees to transfer company funds. AI-generated voices and realistic facial movements made the fraud difficult to detect.

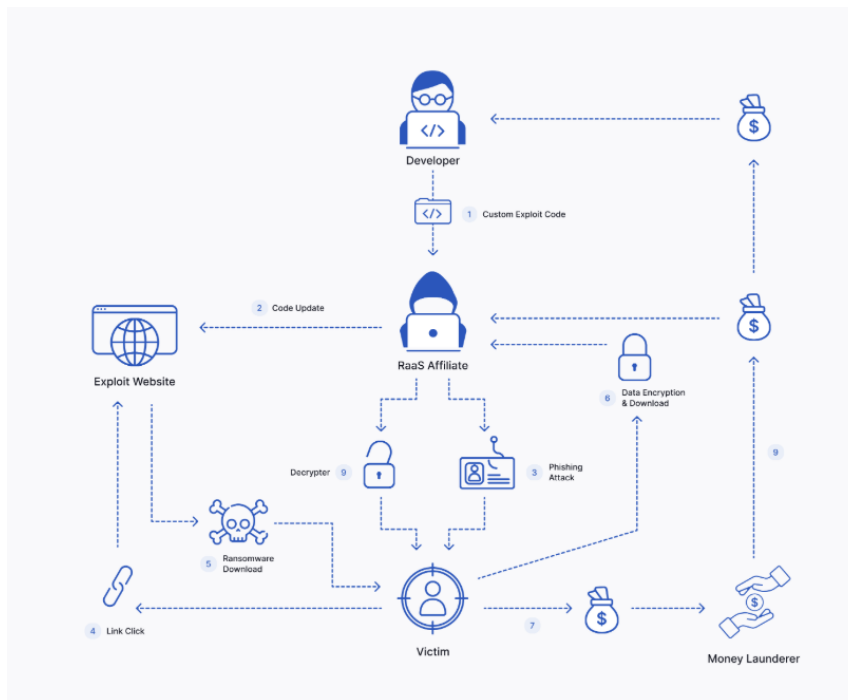
Prevention

- Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)
- Conduct regular phishing awareness training
- Verify financial requests using secondary communication channels
- Deploy AI-powered email filtering solutions

Analyst Observation

Human trust remains the weakest security layer. Even advanced security software can fail if employees unknowingly approve fraudulent requests.

Threat 2 – Ransomware-as-a-Service (RaaS)



Overview

Ransomware has evolved into a commercial business model. Developers now rent ransomware kits to affiliates who conduct attacks and share the profits.

This “Ransomware-as-a-Service” model allows criminals with limited technical expertise to launch sophisticated attacks.

Impact

Individuals

- Permanent loss of personal files
- Financial extortion
- Privacy violations

Organizations

- Operational downtime
- Business interruption
- Legal penalties
- Recovery costs reaching millions of dollars

Real-World Case Study

The 2024 attack on Change Healthcare disrupted healthcare payment systems across the United States. The ransomware attack affected hospitals, pharmacies, and insurance services, highlighting how attacks on one company can impact an entire industry.

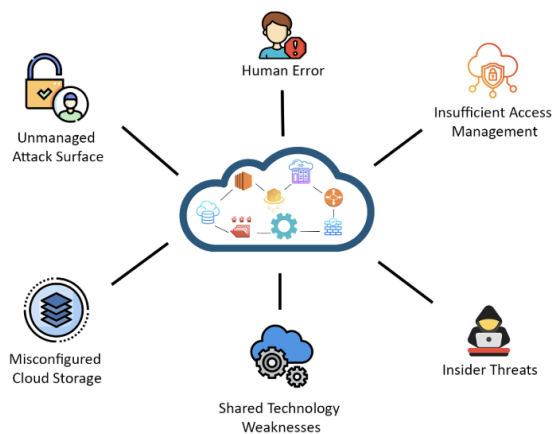
Prevention

- Maintain offline backups
- Regularly update operating systems
- Network segmentation
- Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR)
- Restrict administrative privileges

Analyst Observation

Organizations that maintain tested offline backups recover significantly faster than those relying solely on cloud backups.

Threat 3 – Cloud Security Misconfigurations



Overview

Cloud providers secure their infrastructure, but customers remain responsible for configuring services correctly. Misconfigured storage buckets, excessive user permissions, and exposed APIs continue to cause major data breaches.

Many incidents occur without hackers exploiting software vulnerabilities—misconfigured settings alone expose sensitive information.

Impact

Individuals

- Personal information exposure
- Financial fraud
- Identity theft

Organizations

- Customer data breaches
- Regulatory fines
- Compliance violations
- Loss of customer confidence

Real-World Case Study

The Capital One data breach remains one of the best-known cloud security incidents. A cloud configuration weakness allowed an attacker to access personal information belonging to more than 100 million customers.

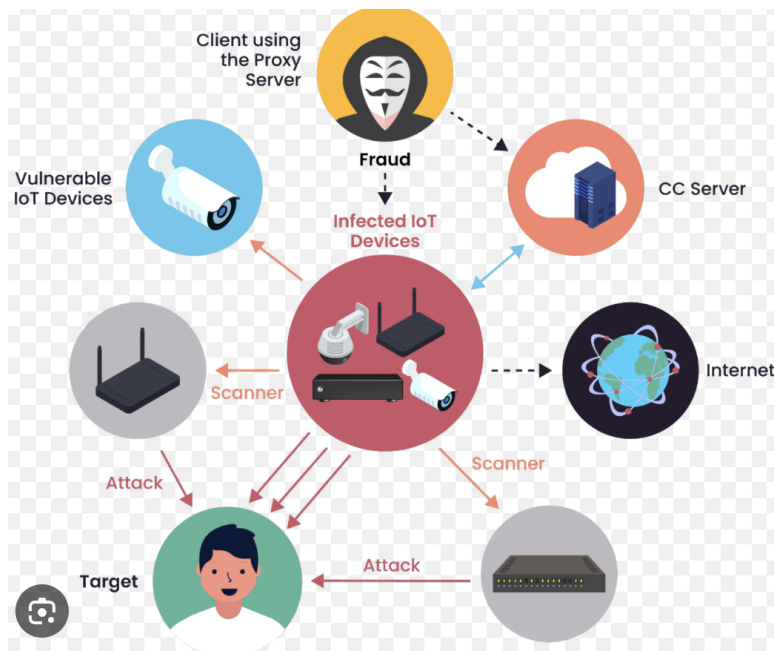
Prevention

- Principle of Least Privilege (PoLP)
- Continuous cloud configuration monitoring
- Encryption of sensitive data
- Regular cloud security audits

Analyst Observation

Cloud environments are generally secure by design; however, human configuration mistakes remain one of the leading causes of cloud data exposure.

Threat 4 – Internet of Things (IoT) Vulnerabilities



Overview

Smart cameras, routers, wearable devices, medical equipment, and industrial sensors are increasingly connected to the internet. Unfortunately, many IoT devices have weak passwords, outdated firmware, or receive limited security updates.

Compromised IoT devices often become part of botnets used to launch Distributed Denial-of-Service (DDoS) attacks.

Impact

Individuals

- Privacy invasion
- Home network compromise
- Device hijacking

Organizations

- Industrial disruption
- Unauthorized network access
- Data interception
- Service outages

Real-World Case Study

The Mirai botnet remains a classic example of insecure IoT devices being used to generate one of the largest DDoS attacks ever recorded. Similar botnet techniques continue to appear in newer malware families during 2024–2025.

Prevention

- Change default passwords
- Update firmware regularly
- Disable unused services
- Place IoT devices on separate network segments

Analyst Observation

Convenience often outweighs security during IoT deployment, creating long-term vulnerabilities that remain unnoticed for years.

Threat 5 – Zero-Day Exploits

Overview

A Zero-Day vulnerability is a software flaw discovered and exploited before developers release a security patch. Since defenders have no immediate fix available, attackers gain a significant advantage.

Government agencies, cybercriminal groups, and nation-state actors actively search for zero-day vulnerabilities.

Impact

Individuals

- Device compromise
- Credential theft
- Malware installation

Organizations

- Data breaches
- Intellectual property theft
- Business disruption
- Targeted espionage

Real-World Case Study

In 2024, multiple organizations were affected by zero-day vulnerabilities in enterprise VPN and firewall appliances. Attackers exploited these flaws before security updates became available, allowing unauthorized access to corporate networks.

Prevention

- Rapid patch deployment
- Zero Trust Architecture
- Threat Intelligence monitoring
- Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR)

Analyst Observation

Organizations that subscribe to threat intelligence feeds often detect exploitation attempts much earlier than those relying only on antivirus software.

3. Key Findings

Threat	Likelihood	Business Impact	Overall Risk
AI Phishing	Very High	High	Critical
Ransomware	Very High	Very High	Critical
Cloud Misconfiguration	High	High	High
IoT Vulnerabilities	Medium	High	High
Zero-Day Exploits	Medium	Critical	Critical

4. Conclusion

Cybersecurity in 2025 is defined by speed, automation, and adaptability. Attackers are increasingly using AI, cloud technologies, and sophisticated malware to exploit organizations of every size. The traditional approach of relying only on antivirus software is no longer sufficient.

Organizations must combine technology with employee awareness, continuous monitoring, and proactive threat intelligence. Security should become an ongoing business process rather than a one-time implementation.

Looking ahead, Artificial Intelligence will play a dual role—empowering both attackers and defenders. Security professionals must therefore continue learning new technologies, monitoring emerging threats, and adopting adaptive defense strategies to stay ahead of cybercriminals.

Cybersecurity is ultimately not about eliminating every risk; it is about reducing risk to a level where organizations can operate confidently in an increasingly digital world.

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